

Peptides 101

A plain-language guide to what peptides actually are, how they work in the body, and why this category of science is getting so much attention. Education only — no treatment claims.

- #WhatArePeptides
- #TheCategories
- #KnowBeforeYouGo

What Is A Peptide?

A peptide is a **short chain of amino acids** — the same building blocks that make up proteins, just smaller. Your body makes thousands of them naturally; they act as **messengers**, telling cells what to do. Think "key fitting a lock," not a sledgehammer.

2–50

Amino acids typically make up a peptide chain

Signal

Each peptide tends to target one specific pathway

⚠ THE MOST IMPORTANT THING TO UNDERSTAND

"Peptide" is a **category, not a single product** — and the regulatory status varies enormously from one to the next. A few are FDA-approved medications. Some are common in cosmetics. Many are **research compounds only**, meaning they have not been approved for use in people.

THREE VERY DIFFERENT REGULATORY WORLDS

TIER	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW TO RECOGNIZE IT
FDA-Approved	Reviewed for safety and effectiveness for a specific use. The highest bar.	Brand name, label, approved indication. Licensed pharmacy, prescription required.
Cosmetic / Topical	Used on the surface of the skin in regulated skincare. Common and well understood.	Found in serums and creams. Appearance claims, not internal medical ones.
Research-Use-Only	Made for laboratory study. Not approved for use in people.	Sold to "labs and researchers." No prescription workflow.

THE CATEGORIES YOU'LL HEAR ABOUT

CATEGORY Recovery - Tissue repair & healing research - Gut-lining, wound-healing studies	CATEGORY Aesthetics - Collagen & elastin signaling - Some forms used topically	CATEGORY Metabolic - Energy & fat-metabolism studies - Includes the GLP-1 class*	CATEGORY Longevity - Cellular-aging research - Mostly research-stage
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The Smart Questions

If you ever consider anything in this category, these are the questions that protect you. A trustworthy provider will answer all of them clearly and in writing.

- #AskFirst
- #StaySafe

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

ASK

The Source

- "Where is this sourced from?"
- "Is it from a licensed pharmacy?"

ASK

The Status

- "Is this **FDA-approved** for this use?"
- "Or is it research-only?"

ASK

The Oversight

- "Who is supervising this medically?"
- "What's the follow-up plan?"

ASK

The Evidence

- "What does the research show?"
- "In people, or only in labs?"

GREEN FLAGS

Licensed pharmacy sourcing, prescription required, clear medical supervision, honest about what's known and unknown, realistic expectations.

RED FLAGS

"Trust us" instead of documentation, pressure to decide fast, miracle promises, no prescription or supervision, vague sourcing.

THE HELLO GORGEOUS PHILOSOPHY

We'd rather give you honest information than a quick sale. Peptide science is genuinely exciting, and it's also young, and full of products that haven't earned the safety record approved medications have. If you ever have questions, bring them to us. We're still here, still learning, still in your corner.

Curious About Peptide Therapy?

Hello Gorgeous offers **\$49 NP-supervised peptide consults** — BPC-157, Sermorelin, GHK-Cu, PT-141, NAD+ & more, sourced exclusively from licensed US compounding pharmacies. Never research-grade. Never gray-market.